EVALUATING THE IMAGINED HAMMARKULLEN

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Evaluating participatory and co-design processes

PROJECT PLAN

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Abstract

The purpose of this research is to create a tool for measuring the impact of projects with a participatory and co-design focus and implement it. The projects that will be studied were integrated in past workshops of the studio *Design and Planning for Social Inclusion* provided by the Master's Programme *Design for Sustainable Development*.

Ultimately, this research aims to develop an evaluation methodology, to be applied in future projects and plans.

Due to time constraints, this master thesis will focus on the implementation of the impact evaluation framework only to few interventions although several other studies will be reviewed and analysed in order to define the main criteria for the evaluation.

By learning, analysing and evaluating the impact of these past projects, this research aims to be not only a more thorough learning experience about participatory and co-design processes but also to contribute to this design studio's next projects, with a sound impact evaluation framework.

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Personal Motivation

I always believed that people should be given the opportunity to voice their problems and needs. Only then can we hope to address them in the most proper way.

Coming from a family of emigrants scattered around the world, I can't help but to feel connected with discriminated minorities and displaced people worldw, that every day have to deal with issues such as deprivation and segregation. Ever since I was very young I was told numerous life experiences that were marked by these issues, and thus I was primed to feel attached to them.

After visiting Hammarkullen for the first time this summer, I was able to learn and experience residents and students of different fields coming together in the Dare 2 Build project. There, I saw an opportunity to bring this good practices back to my home country and raise awareness about their impact.

Henceforth, I intend to merge my studies in civil engineering and urban planning with an opportunity to learn more about this subject in particular.

Background

The Million Homes Programme marked numerous residential zones in Swedish cities, built in the timespan between 1965 and 1974. These areas, including Hammarkullen, had to adapt to periods of mass immigration. Over the last years, many have come as refugees, from Bosnia, Somalia and now the Middle East. Today, some of these areas represent a intense connotation of segregated, marginalised housing.

Many regional and national projects have bloomed in an attempt to increase resilience and social welfare among its residents. Housing companies have made efforts through the means of local projects and overall management, that are mainly focused on a resident-orientated approach. Despite the efforts, many of the public interventions have brought very little significance for the ones they were meant for. The top-down approach is evident in certain measures applied, showing a lack of local community planning.

A problem that seems to persist with most of the larger housing companies and their respective Million Homes estates is a consistent neglect when it comes to maintenance. Major works in renovation are massively opposed by the ones who reside there, as it would increase the value and rents of these properties and the latter would not be able to afford them.

Design and Planning for Social Inclusion is a design studio within the Master's Programme *Design for Sustainable Development* (Department of Architecture and Civil Engineering), that challenges its students to intervene in the aforementioned areas. It provides professional tools aimed for architects, designers, planners, engineers, etc. to analyse and design sustainable solutions through methods of citizen participation.

The studio projects are meant to put participatory and co-design processes in practice, by allowing its students to, not only have a basic theoretical knowledge, but also to be creative and apply it at will.

Theoretical Context

The alienation of the urban designer has proven to be directly related to the fact that our cities have become placeless and lifeless, designed for anything but people (Jacobs and Appleyard, 1987).

Through time, citizen participation in governance and planning has proven to be imperative, as people are connected to their own community and the space they occupy. According to Hamdi (2014), participation means people taking responsibility with or in partnership with other stakeholders in the governance of an area. It is a means to success when it comes to urban design and also to effectiveness, as it is a tool to access information that a designer could never reach without a participatory process.

As a result, citizen participation processes are largely agreed upon and used as a tool for designing and rethinking urban spaces in the present day (Bryson and Quick, 2012). In many European countries, it goes beyond voting on representatives. It can also be the involvement and engagement of people inhabiting, working and using a urban space.

Participatory design and co-design, in particular, focus on the premise of working *with* stakeholders in a collaborative way within the designing development process in order to make the outcomes meet their needs and make sure that they are, indeed, usable.

Co-design and participatory design, though they are related, are not identical terms. Co-design has its roots in the participatory design techniques developed in Scandinavia in the 1970s, research projects on developing strategies and techniques for workers to influence the design and use of computer applications at the workplace, as mentioned by Gregory (2003). This approach aimed to see the user as a person that tries to actively express and idealize possible design solutions, as in user-centered design, the role of the user is slightly more passive (Jäppinen and Mattelmäki, 2015).

On the other hand, co-design stands for collective creativity as it is applied across the whole span of a design process. It is the creativity of designers and people not trained in design working together in the design development process (Sanders and Stappers, 2007).

Objectives

Hammarkullen was subject to many urban interventions with a strong participatory and co-design focus. By learning, analysing and evaluating the impact of the past projects, this research aims to be a more thorough learning experience about participatory and co-design processes and to contribute to these design studio's next projects, with an impact evaluation framework.

With the belief these processes have a great weight when it comes to designing sustainable, usable and resourceful urban spaces, the objectives of this research would be the following:

- Elaborate a literature review;
- Analysing a determined number of participatory and co-design workshops lead by Chalmers' students;
- Defining evaluation criteria to analyse the impact of these workshops (and putting them in comparison with more traditional processes);
- Presenting measures that would strengthen the impact of future projects;
- Reflecting upon the possibility of importing these methods to other geographical contexts, namely Porto (Portugal).

The aim of this approach is also to build a theoretical and practical exchange platform, enabled by this Erasmus+ mobility programme.

Methods

To conduct this research in the given timeframe, the proposed methods are the following:

Theoretical study to understand the emergence and importance of participatory and co-design processes and also to uncover some impact evaluation tools already implemented;

Definition of the selection criteria for choosing the set of workshops to be studied in detail, by reading reports, networking with students and teachers that were involved in them;

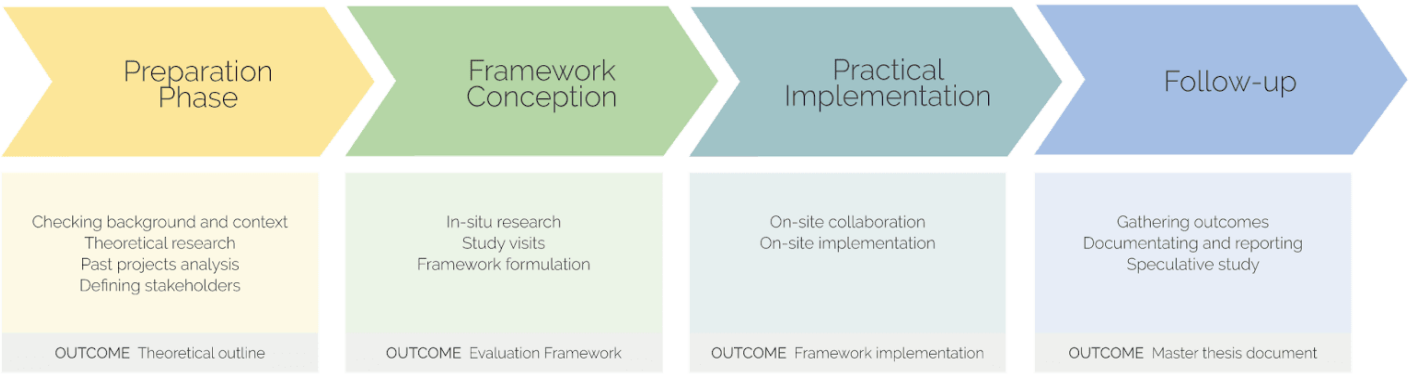
Definition of the impact evaluation criteria to implement in these workshops, through **in-situ research *and study visits*** - observation, interviews with the residents and feedback sessions with participants of past workshops;

On-site collaboration with the next summer course provided by the Department of Architecture and Civil Engineering, Dare 2 Build.

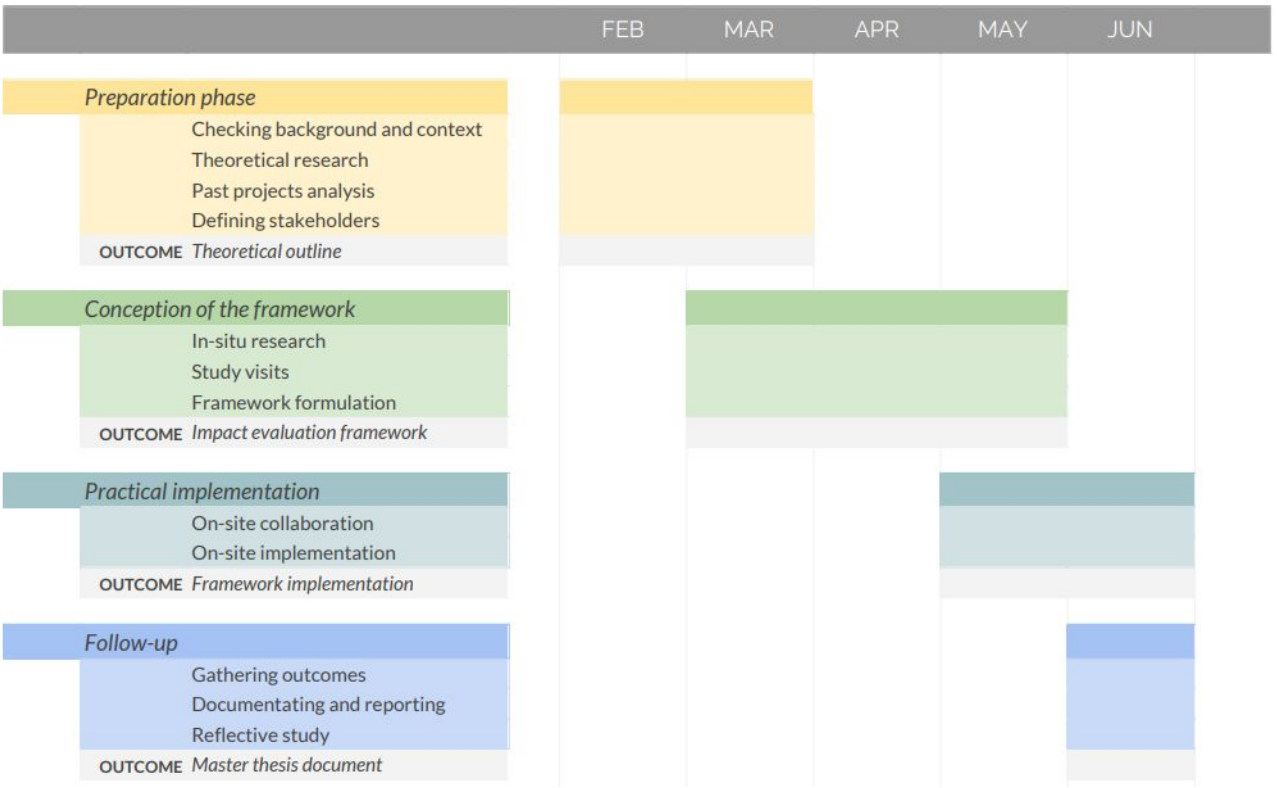
Practical implementation of the impact evaluation framework in a final participatory workshop aimed to evaluate the Dare 2 Build outcomes.

Gathering outcomes and formulate recommendations that would strengthen the impact of future projects;

Reflective study on importing these models to to other geographical contexts.



Work Plan



Mainly due to the time limitations imposed by the exchange, this master thesis will focus on the design and implementation of the impact evaluation framework.

This project plan is made under many assumptions, and those might affect the outcomes of this process, such as the involvement with other students, teachers and residents, existence of ongoing projects during this specific time frame, among others.

Moreover, the language might impose a barrier, thus stressing the importance of collaborating with ongoing or past projects.

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